

Code, except murder."

The Indian Express group, which grew to have multiple editions nationwide in eight languages.

He had access to Mahatma Gandhi, Jawaharlal Nehru, C.R. Rajagopalachari and all the post-Independence greats, such as K. Kamaraj, Jayaprakash Narayan and Indira Gandhi, none of whom hesitated to exploit his grit and ingenuity. An astute Marwari businessman domiciled in Madras, he turned a media baron, assiduously accumulating credits by rendering political or monetary favours or putting in a word for someone who needed assistance, asking for nothing in return. This constituted a valuable bank of ous. Though without legal training, he had a layman's mastery over law and revelled in litigation with the aid of some of the best legal minds in the country. Though a deeply religious man and a Gandhian, to him the end justified the means. His maxim was to "disobey and explain" rather than "obey and complain". He had the most unlikely friends and no dearth of



Q: Which newspaper did he bring out before he took over The Indian Express?

A: The Free Press Journal, in 1932

Q: Which editor did he remove from The Indian Express and went on to appoint again?

A: Arun Shourie

Q: Goenka crossed swords with which major industrialist?

A: Dhirubhai Ambani

Q: Jawaharlal Nehru asked Goenka to employ a member of his family. Who was he?

A: Feroze Gandhi. He was brought in as general manager

Q: What was the name of the character based on him in Mani Ratnam's film Guru?

A: Manikdas Gupta, played by Mithun Chakraborty

enemies. He lived by his wits, displayed a volcanic temper and would curse violently and fluently in many languages. He was miserly but could be extraordinarily generous and warm-hearted.

He turned away from the Congress after it split in 1969. He then championed and financed Jayaprakash Narayan's Bihar movement. His finest hour was during the Emergency. He became an implacable enemy of Indira Gandhi who trained the whole weight of official machinery against him. Despite ill health, RNG remained bloodied but unbowed. The climax was reached in the corporate-media-courtroom war over the early growth of Dhirubhai Ambani's Reliance empire, with him leading the charge despite failing health and growing concerns over what would happen to the Express empire after him. Sadly, the family was divided and before long the group split. The legend survives.

The author was the editor of The Indian Express between 1982 and 1986

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